



Efrain Plascencia

AI SOLUTIONS ARCHITECT · APPLIED AI & AGENTIC SYSTEMS · AUTOMOTIVE SOFTWARE

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01 PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

AI solutions architect turning messy operational problems into shipped AI systems people use every day — not demos. At GEMMACON North America, an automotive software consultancy serving international OEMs, designs and deploys the AI-driven systems client engagements run on: agentic intelligence pipelines, automated document generation, and containerized FastAPI services. Specializes in getting requirements right from stakeholders who haven't articulated them yet, then designing so the humans using the system can't easily get it wrong. Grounded in 15 years of connected-vehicle software and validation — telematics architecture, ECU diagnostics, HIL and vehicle testing — at Toyota, Mercedes-Benz R&D North America, Hyundai Autoever, and PACCAR — the background that earns OEM stakeholders' trust in the first meeting.

02 CORE COMPETENCIES

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|--|-------------------------------------|
| 01 Agentic AI Systems & Workflows | 02 LLM Integration & RAG |
| 03 Forward-Deployed Engineering | 04 Requirements Discovery & Scoping |
| 05 Rapid Prototyping to Production | 06 Python / FastAPI Service Design |
| 07 Document & Reporting Automation | 08 Technical Pre-Sales & Proposals |
| 09 Executive & Stakeholder Communication | 10 Connected Vehicle & Telematics |
| 11 DCM / Infotainment / OTA Systems | 12 Embedded & Cloud Integration |
| 13 Bug Triage & Root-Cause Analysis | 14 Cross-Functional Tech Leadership |
| 15 Global Team Coordination | |

03 PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE & EDUCATION

EXPERIENCE Director of AI Deployment & Solutions

APR 2023 — PRESENT

GEMMACON North America · Long Beach, CA (Remote from DFW)

- Joined as OTA Test Manager; promoted to Head of Business Development & Engineering within a year, then to Director of AI Deployment & Solutions in 2025 — leading the North America practice's AI systems, commercial strategy, and technical recruiting across engagements for Mercedes-Benz, Porsche, and NVIDIA.
- Designed and deployed an agentic intelligence system: structured search sweeps over a target-company database, a four-signal taxonomy with a 20-point scoring rubric and threshold gating, and automated briefing generation into Notion.
- Built the time-tracking and billing system for the NVIDIA engagement — encoding non-obvious business rules (per-engineer daily minimums, billed-vs-actual payroll reconciliation) with a containerized FastAPI reporting service, designed for error resistance by non-technical users.
- Shipped a Python document pipeline that converts client JIRA exports into branded executive decks, and a candidate-profiling tool that scores resumes against job descriptions and renders client-ready deliverables.

- Built and lead a cross-functional technical team from the ground up — growing engineering headcount 300% and serving as primary technical liaison across OEM programs, validating software for infotainment head units, domain controllers, and SDV architectures.

EXPERIENCE Lead Test Engineer

DEC 2022 — APR 2023

PACCAR · Lewisville, TX

- Led end-to-end validation for a new commercial-vehicle electrical/electronic architecture.
- Coordinated with Tier-1 suppliers, embedded software teams, and program management to meet aggressive release milestones.
- Designed and executed test strategies covering in-vehicle ECU communication, diagnostics, and backend network integration.
- Triaged failures and drove root-cause analysis across hardware and software stacks.

EXPERIENCE Senior Test Engineer — Connected Services

MAR 2020 — DEC 2022

Toyota Motor North America · Plano, TX

- Owned end-to-end validation of user profile, registration, and account-activation flows across mobile app, vehicle head unit, and cloud backend for Toyota connected-vehicle applications — serving as technical escalation point and leading global defect triage with Japan HQ.

EXPERIENCE End-to-End Quality Engineer

MAR 2017 — MAR 2020

Mercedes-Benz R&D North America · Long Beach, CA

- Led end-to-end testing of integrated vehicle systems — head unit, smartphones, digital assistants (Siri, Alexa), wearables, and IoT devices — on premium infotainment and telematics platforms, closing cross-system integration defects for multi-market launches.

EXPERIENCE Quality Engineer — Telematics

2013 — 2017

Hyundai Autoever Telematics America · Fountain Valley, CA

- Designed QA processes for Hyundai telematics — DCM, head unit, and backend connectivity — validating hardware-software integrations across embedded firmware, cloud APIs, and mobile clients in a startup-scale environment.

EDUCATION Bachelor of Science, Computer Science

2008 — 2012

California State University, Long Beach · Long Beach, CA

- Four-year degree in Computer Science — foundation in systems, algorithms, and software architecture.

04 TECHNICAL SKILLS & TOOLS

AI & AGENTIC SYSTEMS

Agentic pipelines and workflows, LLM integration (OpenAI, Perplexity), RAG, prompt engineering, scoring rubrics and threshold gating, AI agents for engineering and business workflows

BUILDING & SHIPPING

Python, FastAPI, Docker, REST APIs, document automation (python-pptx), Stripe, OAuth, Vercel, Neon Postgres, Git/GitHub, Linear, Claude Code

AUTOMOTIVE DOMAINS

DCM, Infotainment, Telematics, Connected Vehicle, ECU Communication, OTA Updates, ADAS, Software-Defined Vehicle (SDV)

SYSTEMS & INTEGRATION

Embedded system architecture, hardware/software stack debugging, CAN-based diagnostics exposure, HIL and vehicle testing, backend/cloud API integration, user profile and account service flows

PROCESS & TOOLING

Technical specification authoring, requirements discovery, test case design and validation, defect triage, JIRA, Confluence, Notion, Git, Agile/Scrum, release management

05 HIGHLIGHTS

Guest speaker, Mercedes-Benz R&D North America 2025

Returned to the Long Beach R&D campus — the same site where I led end-to-end vehicle testing eight years earlier — to present on applied AI and large language models in the automotive stack.

06 PROJECTS

The Knew York Times 2026

FOUNDER · [kytimes.ai](#)

- A satirical bestseller-list platform where rankings are openly bought — built, launched, and operated as a real company.
- Designed, built, and launched a production SaaS end-to-end — weekly-updated, genre-specific bestseller lists with bid-based placement, week-by-week archives, and social sharing.
 - Implemented full user management with Google and Apple OAuth — account creation, sessions, and profile flows.
 - Integrated Stripe for payment processing of ranked placements — checkout, billing, and webhook-driven fulfillment.
 - Formed a registered LLC and operate the product as a real business — legal disclaimers, analytics, and affiliate monetization.

[#Linear](#) [#ClaudeCodeCLI](#) [#Vercel](#) [#Neon.Tech](#) [#Stripe](#) [#OAuth](#) [#GitHub](#)

07 CERTIFICATIONS

Designing and Building AI Products and Services 2025

MIT xPRO — Professional Certificate Program

08 LANGUAGES

English NATIVE · Spanish BILINGUAL · *German* VERY VERY VERY LITTLE

XX COMPANION SITE

<https://www.efrain.me/>

